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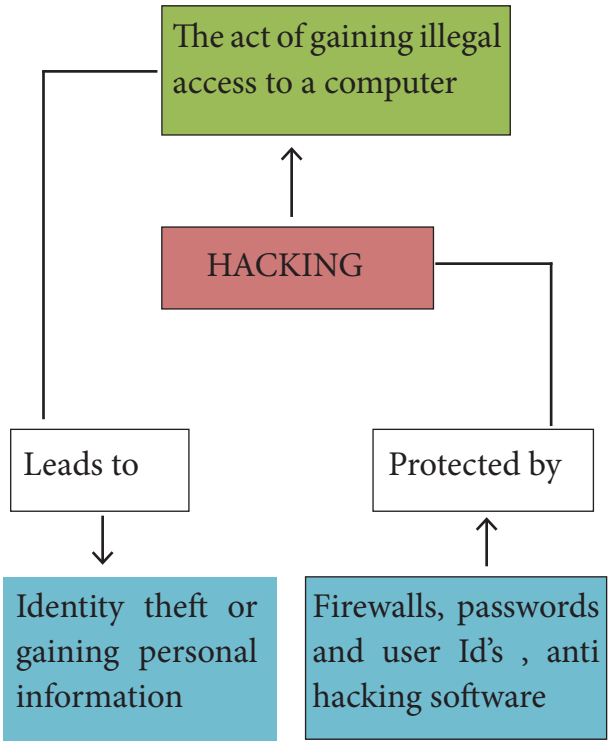

Figure 17.3 Diagramatic representation of Hacking

CRACKING

Cracking is where someone edits a program source so that the code can be exploited or modified. A cracker (also called a black hat or dark side hacker) is a malicious or criminal hacker. "Cracking" means trying to get into computer systems in order to steal, corrupt, or illegitimately view data.

A cracker is someone who breaks into someone else's computer system, often on a network, bypassing passwords or licenses in computer programs.

Software cracking is the most often used type of cracking which is nothing but removing the encoded copy protection. There is another type of cracking called password cracking. This is mainly used to crack the passwords. Password cracking can be perform either by using an automated program or can be manually realized.

One more interesting fact about cracking is social engineering. It is a method of getting passwords and information using human weakness. These crackers trick people, not software. They can use just the phone for getting information, they can pretend being your friend and talk to you on **Internet Relay Chat**(IRC) or by Instant messenger. e-mail can also be a source for them. They may send official e-mail requesting some sensitive information. It may look like a legitimate e-mail from bank or other official institution.

The other method that uses social engineering crackers is password guessing. They find your personal information from some personal data/facts and try to guess a password.

Usually a cracker maintains knowledge of the vulnerabilities he or she finds and exploits them for personal advantage, not revealing them to either to the general public or to the manufacturer.

17.3 Cyber Security and Threats

Cyber attacks are launched primarily for causing significant damage to a computer system or for stealing important information from an individual or from an organization.Cyber security is a collection of various technologies, processes and measures that reduces the risk of cyber attacks and protects organizations and individuals from computer based threats.